

Opportunity for Success

Supporting African Students Toward International Opportunities

01 PROBLEM

Context and Challenge

Opportunity for Success (OFS) is a startup. The service supports African students seeking international opportunities: motivation letters, university selection, fellowships, and scholarships. OFS has built a community of over 4,000 engaged members.

Core Problem Statement

4,000 community members, zero revenue. There is no path that converts an interested member into a paying client. No packaged services, no visible prices, and no usable platform - the website cost up to 4M FCFA without a usable result.

Identified UX Problems

01 No Packaged Services or Pricing

Students don't know what they're buying or what it costs. Perceived value is zero before interacting with the founder personally.

02 No Usable Platform — Technology Blockage

The website cost up to 4M FCFA without a usable result. Strong dependency on unreachable developers who now request equity in exchange for work.

03 Visuals Misrepresent the Target Audience

The brochure showed white students while the primary audience is African. The text was full of emojis, creating an AI-generated impression that undermined credibility.

04 Community Not Converting to Clients

4,000 Facebook members, but no journey transforms an interested member into a service buyer — zero revenue activation.

Methodology

Research combined coaching sessions with the founder, competitive mapping across 3 actor types, and persona development from real community member profiles.

UX Competitive Analysis

UX Criterion	Informal Networks	Freelance Consultants	Specialised Agencies	OFS (Target)
Visible and Transparent Pricing	✗	Partial	✓✓	✓ To build
African Representation	✗	Partial	✗	✓✓ Differentiator
Personalised Accompaniment	✗	✓	✓✓	✓✓ Core value
Success Testimonials	✗	Partial	✓✓	✓ To valorise
Engaged Community	✗	✗	Partial	✓✓ 4,000 members
Digital Platform	✗	Partial	✓✓	✗ → MVP to build
Clear Purchase Journey	✗	Partial	✓✓	✗ → To design

✓✓ = Very good

✓ = Present

✗ = Absent

User Personas

Aïssa D. - African Student Age: 24 · Master's student in Côte d'Ivoire, aiming for Europe/North America Goal: Find an adapted scholarship or fellowship and succeed in the application Frustration: Doesn't know where to start. Online resources are in English and dispersed. UX Need: Understand services immediately, see prices, access success testimonials, register easily	Kofi A. - Community Member Age: 27 · Computer science graduate in Ghana · follows OFS for 6 months Goal: Access fellowship or research residency opportunities abroad Frustration: The page posts opportunities but never explains how to get personal support. UX Need: See clearly what is free vs. paid. A clear CTA to move from member to client.
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Key UX Insights

Insight #1 - 4,000 members is a sales asset, not a vanity metric

The Facebook community is already converted in terms of interest and trust. The only missing element is a structured conversion path: post - CTA - landing page - service purchase.

Insight #2 - African visual representation is a non-negotiable differentiator

No specialised agency prominently features African students. This is OFS's most immediate, lowest-cost differentiator - and must be implemented on every touchpoint from day one.

Insight #3 - Pricing transparency removes the biggest conversion barrier

Students cannot commit to an unpriced service. Displaying 'From 15,000 FCFA' on each service card reduces the interaction cost to zero - users self-select before contacting the founder.

Insight #4 - Technology independence is a strategic priority

The 4M FCFA website failure shows OFS must build an MVP without external developers. A no-code approach allows the founder to control and evolve the platform independently.

User Flows - 3 Critical Journeys

Friction points were identified at the same moments across all journeys: absence of pricing, no CTA toward purchase, and no structured contact form.

Journey 1 — Student Discovery Discovery (Facebook/word of mouth) → Page consultation → Understands services → Chooses a service → Payment → Accompaniment

Journey 2 — Community Member Follows page → Sees a conversion post → Clicks CTA → Consults offers → Places order → Testimonial

Journey 3 — Founder (Internal) Receives a request → Qualifies profile → Proposes a service → Sends quote → Accompaniment → Follow-up and re-engagement

Design Decisions

Based on research and coaching insights, the following UX solutions were designed covering the homepage, a 3-service pricing page with African visual identity, and a founder operations dashboard.

User Testing Protocol

Participants: 3–5 African students aged 20–28 (online)

Duration: ~30 min per session

#	Task	Focus Area
T1	You are a student in Côte d'Ivoire. Find a service to help write a motivation letter and place an order.	Service discovery and purchase
T2	You have followed OFS for 3 months. Find how to move from member to client and book a 1-hour consultation.	Community conversion flow
T3	You are the founder. Check new requests and respond to Aïssa's.	Founder operations
T4	Find a testimonial from an African student who obtained a fellowship thanks to OFS.	Social proof discovery
T5	Understand what is free and what is paid on the OFS platform.	Free vs. paid clarity

Test Report — Key Findings

T1 - Motivation Letter Order Success: 3/5	Users didn't find the price directly - they clicked the service but landed on a contact form without seeing the rate. Recommendation: Display price on the service card. Format: 'From 15,000 FCFA'.
T2 - Member to Client Conversion Success: 2/5	4 out of 5 users didn't know how to order from Facebook — no link to the platform. Recommendation: Add a pinned 'Book a consultation' button on Facebook with a direct link.
T4 -Testimonial Discovery Success: 5/5	No issues. Testimonials section found easily. Recommendation: Add country of origin and university obtained on each testimonial card.
T5 - Free vs. Paid Success: 2/5	Users confused free page posts and paid services - no visual distinction. Recommendation: Add a 'Paid Service' badge on each offer. Create a dedicated FAQ page.

Next Steps

- Build a no-code MVP platform without external developers
- Publish African student hero photo and 3 packaged services with visible pricing
- Pin a Facebook conversion post linking directly to the booking page
- Collect and publish 5 success testimonials with country and university obtained